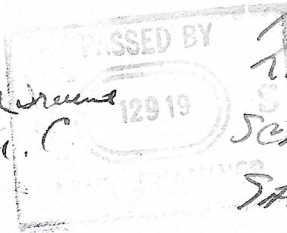


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Mrs. MARTHA DARROUGH
to THE RAN Hospital
School of Nursing
St. Louis 18, Mo.

Albert K. Krauss
Capt. U.S. Army



Dec. 5, 1904
England

My Dear D.,

I know I have been a long time since I wrote you last but I had a lot of letters to write. I still got 3 of your letters to answer. But today I will just answer a long one of Oct 30.

That moon I wrote you about in the last letter is not as big as it was before. But it is still there and that is what counts. I guess with just half of it then we can do just as good much.

I told you about the moon so you would know just how nice the nights are. We do have a wind once in a while but that is not long. The days have been pretty nice too.

I got your Christmas cards & I will write you about that later. But you should see the ones I got over here. I do not feel like sending them to the are so very poor. They seem to not know how to make cards. And that is class birthday cards too. I have not sent mine so I guess they will all get there late. I think I better do that after this letter to you.

I do not have much to say. I got my fingers
cross so I may get to P. M. Christ was busy if
it does happen I will really do some crabby.
Last year at Christmas time I just got to this
country. And was I alone. I sure do not
want to spend any more Christmas like that.
One year from today I left New York. That is
a day I will never forget too.

This letter of yours is ten pages. So if you
think that I can answer that or write that
much you think better than I do. So I could
never write that much.

I did have a 24 hours on Saturday & I saw
a good picture in town. I saw it in camp but
it is good enough to see it again. The picture is
'Going My Way.'

Just getting here a boy gave me a shot of rum.
The whole air is all feel warm. About two more of
them and I would not be a surprise at what
I wrote.

You write & tell me about the pictures & then I
see them. You told me about 3 in this letter.
I will be looking forward to them.

So you go for that rum in the ten days. Well, I

think that I can tell you some good substitute for
 that tin roof in a house. You need a car
 parked on a quiet street. It's really nice to
 listen to that with the radio on. I don't like
 it now. But that time I do not know. The night
 got out with me. I had a girl from school
 who was not much good. But I hope we can
 have a date & try that. What do you say about
 that.

When you said that you can actually at the
 Co'sa Louva that is 25 by 25. But as far as I teach
 you any thing. I don't think that you are very wrong.
 I know a couple of good English dancers but they
 are pretty silly.

There is one thing that I did not like in your letter
 and that is what you said, "The Black Forest is
 a must on my list before I leave this city." I
 do not like that I leave the city for some reason
 I pictured you as always to be liked in St. Louis. But
 goodness know it is not a good place to live in.
 I know how much it means to you. I
 guess I will never see you in St. Louis again. For
 when I get back you will be at home, I guess.

When I get back you will be at home, I guess.
 You asked if I like parks well that is like
 asking me if I like ice cream or playing

football. You were the party in that boat
in the park. And you are the only one who had
a good time with. Need I say any more.

So my letters change from one to the other.
I guess it is the mood I am in. If I want a
luncheon for a letter & it comes and you tell
me some things I liked. Like the night of the
blackout in the boat. I really like that then I
like you more hence a good letter. But I care
as much for you one day as I do the next. Maybe
I can do better.

So you think that Carmichael park is a good
romantic place. Well I have a couple good
places better than that. I will have to show you
cypresses. As I do not want any body else to cut in.
But Carmichael park is only a block & half from
home. So you think that is close enough?
Well I guess that does it for a stage. I hope
that you think I am in a good mood because I am.
I miss you a lot & I still hope that our meeting
is not so far off with a lot of time & may be
Ollie.

P.S. I will include an article for you. Tell me what
you think about it.

A Nurse Writes the Editorial

On Nov. 7, the letter below, addressed to every wounded American soldier on the Continent, was printed in the Paris edition of *The Stars and Stripes*. It was written by 2/Lt. Frances Slanger, a nurse in a U.S. Army field hospital who waded ashore with a hospital platoon on D-4. She mailed the letter on Oct. 21. That evening, 2/Lt. Slanger was killed by a German shell as she huddled together with two other nurses in her tent during a 45-minute enemy barrage in the hospital area. She was the first American nurse in the ETO to die in action. "The wounded do not cry," she wrote. As she lay dying in the arms of her friends, she uttered no word of complaint. She was concerned about the grief her death would bring her family in Boston. She was buried in a military cemetery, flanked on either side by the men she served. Her letter is the finest epitaph for Frances Slanger that could have been written.

Editor, Stars and Stripes:

We hope you will be able to find room for the enclosed article. You see, we had many of these men as patients and that is just the way we feel about it and them. For a change we want them to know how much we think of them.—
2/Lt. Frances Y. Slanger, ANC.

IT is 0200 and I have been lying awake for one hour, listening to the steady, even breathing of the other three nurses in the tent. Thinking about some of the things we had discussed during the day. The rain is beating down on the tent with a torrential force. The wind is on a mad rampage and its main objective seems to be to lift the tent off its poles and fling it about our heads.

Nursing a Spark

The fire is burning low and just a few live coals are on the bottom. With the slow feeding of wood, and finally coal, a roaring fire is started. I couldn't help thinking how similar to a human being a fire is; if it is allowed to run down too low and if there is a spark of life left in it, it can be nursed back. . . . So can a human being. It is slow, it is gradual, it is done all the time in these Field Hospitals and other hospitals in the ETO.

We had read several articles in different magazines and papers sent in by a grateful GI, praising the work of the nurses around the combat areas. Praising us—for what? I climbed back into my cot. Lt. Bowler was the only one I had awakened. I whispered to her. Lt. Cox and Lt. Powers slept on. Fine nurses and great girls to live with. . . of course, like

in all families, an occasional quarrel, but these were quickly forgotten.

I'm writing this by flashlight. In this light it looks something like a "dive." In the center of the tent are two poles, one part chimney, the other a plain tent pole. Kindling wood lies in disorderly confusion on the damp ground. We don't have a tarp on the ground. A French wine pitcher, filled with water, stands by. The GIs say we rough it. We in our little tent can't see it. True, we are set up in tents, sleep on cots and are subject to the temperament of the weather.

We wade ankle deep in mud. You have to lie in it. We are restricted to our immediate area, a cow pasture or hay field, but then, who is not restricted? We have a stove and coal. We even have a laundry line in the tent. Our GI drawers are at this moment doing the dance of the pants what with the wind howling, the tent waving precariously, the rain beating down, the guns firing, and me with a flashlight, writing. It all adds up to a feeling of unreality.

Sure, we rough it, but in comparison to the way you men are taking it, we can't complain, nor do we feel that bouquets are due us. But you, the men behind the guns, the men driving our tanks, flying our planes, sailing our ships, building bridges and to the men who pave the way and to the men who are left behind—it is to you we doff our helmets. To every GI wearing the American uniform, for you we have the greatest admiration and respect.

The Injured Kid Us

Yes this time we are handing out the bouquets . . . but after taking care of some of your buddies; seeing them when they are brought in bloody, dirty with the earth, mud and grime, and most of them so tired. Somebody's brothers, somebody's fathers and somebody's sons. Seeing them gradually brought back to life, to consciousness and to see their lips separate into a grin when they first welcome you. Usually they kid, hurt as they are. It doesn't amaze us to hear one of them say, "How'ya babe," or "Holy Mackerel, an American woman!" or most indiscreetly, "How about a kiss?"

These soldiers stay with us but a short time, from ten days to possibly two weeks. We have learned a great deal about our American soldier, and the stuff he is made of. The wounded do not cry. Their buddies come first. The patience and determination they show, the courage and fortitude they have is sometimes awesome to behold. It is we who are proud to be here. Rough it? No. It is a privilege to be able to receive you, and a great distinction to see you open your eyes and with that swell American grin, say, "Hi-ya babe!"—2/Lt. Frances Slanger, 2/Lt. Christine Cox, 2/Lt. Margaret M. Bowler, 1/Lt. Elizabeth F. Powers, ANC.